

# SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

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## EDUCATION

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| <b>University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign</b>                    | Champaign, Illinois               |
| Master of Science in Statistics                                   | August 2025 - May 2027 (Expected) |
| Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.92/4.00)               | January 2023 - May 2025           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Mathematics Minor</li></ul> |                                   |

## WORK EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                              |
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| <b>STAT107 Data Science Discovery</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Champaign, Illinois          |
| <i>Undergraduate Course Assistant</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | August 2023 - Present        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Facilitate learning for over 100 students by assisting students in grasping fundamental data science concepts by conducting interactive sessions, and providing clarifications on course materials</li><li>Manage Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials</li><li>Collaborate with a team of 100+ staff and 2 professors in weekly meetings</li></ul> |                              |
| <b>STAT443 Professional Statistics</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Champaign, Illinois          |
| <i>Undergraduate Course Assistant</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | January 2025 - Present       |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Grade assignments and provide feedback to 20+ students on statistical analysis and consulting using Canvas LMS</li><li>Evaluate 5+ student presentations to ensure alignment with course expectations and grading criteria</li><li>Act as a client in mock consulting projects, providing insights and posing real-world challenges</li></ul>                                                                                  |                              |
| <b>Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts &amp; Sciences</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Champaign, Illinois          |
| <i>AI/ML Intern Team Leader</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | January 2024 - December 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Lead a team of 5 interns.</li><li>Develop predictive machine learning models with large data sets(100,000+ entries) using Python</li><li>Utilize advanced techniques: XGBoost, Random Forests, Regression, Neural Networks, BERT, Transformers</li><li>Collaborate closely with 3 coordinators in weekly meetings to align project goals and track progress</li></ul>                                                          |                              |

## PROJECTS/AWARDS

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                |
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| <b>Graduation Prediction Model</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | September 2024 - December 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records</li><li>Built an interactive Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors, enabling real-time graduation predictions for university administrators</li></ul> |                                |
| <b>3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | September 2024                 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss</li><li>Proposed data-driven interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis</li></ul>                                 |                                |

## SKILLS

|               |                                                                                             |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Languages:    | English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)        |
| Computer:     | Python (Advanced), R (Intermediate), Git (Intermediate), Tableau (Basic), Office (Advanced) |
| Certificates: | Data Science DISCOVERY, Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate   |

## COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                |
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| <b>Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | September 2024 - December 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                 |                                |
| <b>Treasurer in Performance UIUC Touch</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | February 2023 - May 2024       |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Strategically plan and execute 10 fundraising initiatives to support team activities, costumes, and travel expenses, resulting in a 30% increase in available funds compared to the previous year</li><li>Showcase talent by performing at renowned events elevating the visibility of Performance UIUC Touch within the dance community and attracting 100+ new followers on social media platforms</li></ul> |                                |
| <b>Translator for the US Army</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | June 2021-December 2022        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Served as a translator for over 2,000 US soldiers and Korean soldiers during joint USFK training exercises</li><li>Assisted newly stationed US soldiers in navigating South Korea,resulting in a 95% satisfaction rate among newly stationed soldiers regarding their acclimation process</li></ul>                                                                                                            |                                |